

• SHOOTING SCRIPT • V3 • FINAL

What If

A 58-second film that asks an FMCG commercial team one question they cannot answer with a spreadsheet, then shows them the tool that can.

CLIENT Smart Value AI Solutions	PRODUCT Price Optimizer	ON CAMERA Mariam Ghabrial Marketing & PR Director, Marketeers
POSTING FROM Smart Value AI Solutions	RUNTIME 0:58	SPOKEN WORDS 134
MASTER RATIO 1:1 · 9:16 cutdown	PRIMARY PLATFORM LinkedIn	

0:00 HOOK	0:08 THE FOUR SHOPPERS	0:31 PRICE OPTIMIZER	0:49 CLOSE
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☐ ON CAMERA — 17S ☐ VOICE-OVER — 41S SEGMENTS DRAWN TO ACTUAL DURATION

BEFORE THE SCRIPT

Three calls made against the brief

Each of these changes something the brief specified. Each is reversible, and the reversal is written out so nobody has to reconstruct it.

NAMING

The product is Price Optimizer, not Smart Value

The brief called the subject "Smart Value Pricing Optimization." The company deck is more precise: **Smart Value AI Solutions** is the company, **Price Optimizer** is what clients buy, sitting beside Promotion Planner and AI-Enabled Market Research.

A viewer who wants this has to be able to ask for it by name, and "Smart Value Pricing Optimization" is not something they can ask for. The film is about one decision, so naming the one product that makes it is sharper than naming the company and leaving them to find the right door.

WAS

~~Smart Value runs the question before you
commit.~~

NOW



**Price Optimizer runs the question before you
commit.**

Eight words either way. If house policy is to lead with the parent brand, revert this line and change nothing else.

POSITIONING

The end card uses the line you already own

Smart Value already says **"Decision support, powered by AI. Predict before you decide,"** and the deck already says decisions are tested through simulation rather than analysed after the fact. That is the thesis of this film, which is a good sign.

So the end card carries the existing brand line. The earlier draft closed on "Before you change the price, simulate the decision," which is a serviceable line that duplicates yours at lower strength. It moves to the post caption. One line on screen, one in Mariam's mouth, same argument.

PROOF

The 92% figure stays off the screen

The deck carries a real proof point: **92% confidence on an actual pricing recommendation**, models validated against real market outcomes. It is the strongest asset available and I have deliberately kept the number off the end card.

A specific figure on screen for two seconds invites "92% of what, measured how" from exactly the people this film is aimed at, and there is no room to answer them. Unqualified it reads as marketing. Qualified it needs a sentence. So the end card carries the softer validation line and the number goes in the caption, where there is room and where the people who care enough to ask are already reading.

SIGN-OFF REQUIRED

Confirm the exact wording of the 92% claim with whoever owns it before it appears anywhere, caption included.

THE FILM

Script and direction

0:00
0:08

8 SEC

ON CAMERA

Hook

MARIAM

"What if you put 8% on your best-selling SKU?
Someone in the room will say revenue goes up.
Will it?"

DIRECTION

Open mid-thought. **No logo, no greeting, no name card.** The first three seconds are the most valuable real estate in the film and a title card spends them on the wrong thing.

Cut on "Will it?" to half a second of hard silence before the graphics start. Do not fill it with music. The pause is the question landing.

ON-SCREEN TEXT – FRAME ONE

+8% on your best seller. Top third, up from the first frame, so the film reads with the sound off.

0:08

0:31

23 SEC

VOICE-OVER

The four shoppers

VOICE-OVER

"Depends who's standing in the aisle.

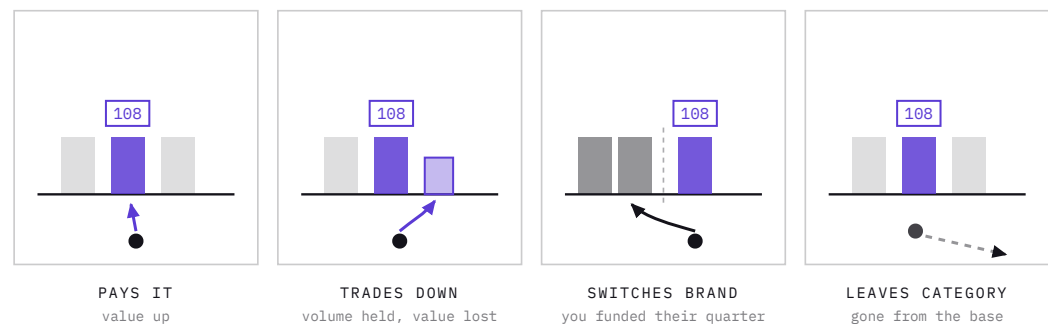
Some pay it and never notice.

Some drop to the smaller pack. You kept the shopper and lost the value.

A few walk one shelf across to the competitor.

And a few just stop buying the category.

Same decision, four different answers, and your forecast only modelled one."



Storyboard, 0:08–0:29. One shelf, held for the whole section, with the price tag flipped from 100 to 108. Each shopper path draws on its line and stays on screen, so by "four different answers" all four are visible at once over the same shelf.

BEAT BY BEAT

aisle The shelf draws in. One price tag flips 100 to 108.

pay it A path runs straight to the SKU, stays green, volume bar barely moves.

smaller pack The path bends down the shelf to a smaller pack of the same brand. Volume holds, value drops. Label the drop.

one shelf across The path leaves the brand block and takes the competitor's colour. **Let this beat land hardest.** It is the expensive one.

stop buying The path fades out of frame. Brief drop in the mix.

four answers All four replay at once, fast, over the same shelf. Four tiles resolve together: volume, revenue, margin, share.

modelled one

Three tiles grey out. One stays lit.

ON-SCREEN TEXT

Pays it · Trades down · Switches brand · Leaves the category Then, on
the four-tile resolve: **One price change. Four P&Ls.**

0:31
0:49

18 SEC

VOICE-OVER

Price Optimizer

VOICE-OVER

"Price Optimizer runs the question before you commit.
Move the price. Watch volume, margin and the portfolio move with it.
See where the switching goes. See where the shopper stops paying.
Test it on screen, not in the market."

DIRECTION

Hand off from the illustrated shelf to real UI **in the same colour language**, so it reads as the same argument rather than a new chapter.

- runs the question The +8% from the hook appears as a scenario row. Same number, loop closed.
- move the price A slider moves, outputs recalculate live. **Do not cut during the recalculation.** The whole point is that the numbers move together.
- the portfolio Pull back to the full SKU list. Two or three neighbouring SKUs move the other way. That shows cannibalisation without narrating it.
- switching goes Switching flows between brands.
- stops paying Willingness to pay curve, threshold marked. Land on the cliff edge.
- not in the market +4%, +8% and +12% stack side by side with different winners. Hold two seconds. **This is the money frame.**

ON-SCREEN TEXT

Simulate. Then decide.

Screens to source for the edit

- 01 Scenario row set to +8% on a single SKU
- 02 Price slider mid-move with outputs recalculating
- 03 Full portfolio view with neighbouring SKUs reacting

- 04 Switching or source-of-volume view between brands
- 05 Willingness to pay curve with the threshold visible
- 06 Three scenarios compared side by side

CAPTURE NOTE

Record at the highest resolution available with **real cursor movement**, not static screenshots. A still screen pretending to be a live one is obvious on a 2× timeline, and this audience watches software demos for a living.

0:49
0:58

9 SEC

ON CAMERA

Close

MARIAM

"So the question was never 'can we raise the price.'
It's 'what happens when we do.'
Simulate it first."

DIRECTION

Back to the opening setup, same lighting, **framed wider than the hook**. Calmer than the hook. Pulling back signals resolution; going tighter would read as escalation, which is the wrong note for a line about thinking before acting.

Hold a full beat on her face after the last word. Do not cut on the word.

END CARD - 0:56 TO 0:58

Smart Value AI Solutions
Price Optimizer
Predict before you decide. Small, beneath the line: **Models validated against real market outcomes.**

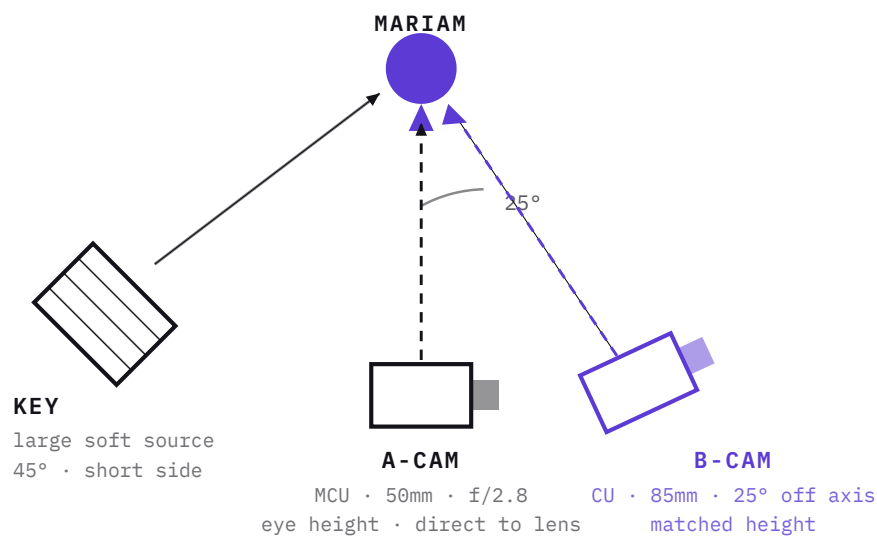
CAMERA

Shot list and angles

Only two on-camera setups in this film, so both have to work hard. The two-camera plan below is the single highest-value production decision on the day, because it is what makes the punch-in possible.

BACKGROUND – 2 STOPS UNDER, DEFOCUSED

○ practical for separation



Overhead plan, both setups. The same floor plan serves the hook and the close; only the A-cam framing changes between them. B-cam sits 25° off the A-cam axis so a cut between them never reads as a jump.

16:9 CAPTURE — PROTECTION ONLY

**1:1 DELIVERY — FRAME TO THIS**

subject on the left third · text zone right · generous headroom

Framing for square. Compose to the violet square, not the dashed 16:9. Centred framing collides with the text overlay, which is why she sits on the left third. Square punishes tight headroom faster than widescreen, so give more than instinct suggests.

TWO CAMERAS

A-CAM MCU, chest up · ~50mm equiv · f/2.8–f/4 · eye height or 1–2° below · direct to lens
 B-CAM CU, shoulders up · ~85mm equiv · 25° off A-cam axis · matched height

This gives the editor a clean cut anywhere without a jump cut. **If only one camera is available**, shoot every line twice at both sizes and match the performance.

HOOK — 0:00

Start on A-cam, direct address. She is asking the viewer a question, so any off-axis eyeline turns it into an interview and the question stops being aimed at anyone.

Camera locked off, or a **2 to 3% push across the eight seconds**. Imperceptible, but it adds forward pressure. No handheld. Handheld reads as vlog, and this film is asking for commercial authority.

THE PUNCH-IN

Cut to B-cam on **"Will it?"**. This is the most valuable two seconds of coverage in the film.

Drop-off concentrates around the five-second mark, and a hard size change right at that point resets attention without spending a word. Cut **on** the question, not after it.

CLOSE – 0:49

A-cam, medium shot, waist up, direct to lens. Wider than the hook, same lighting, same background.

Consider one cut to B-cam on "Simulate it first," but only if the take supports it. If her delivery is strong, stay wide and let it play. A cut there can look like you did not trust the line.

LIGHTING

Soft key at about 45°, large source, **short side**. Keying the far side of her face from camera gives shape and reads more serious than flat frontal light. Background one and a half to two stops under.

Avoid a white cyc. This audience recognises white-cyc corporate video as an ad within a second and scrolls past it.

**BACKGROUND
& WARDROBE**

Real environment, defocused. Office or meeting room, not a branded backdrop. Nothing readable behind her head, and **check this in the square crop rather than the 16:9**, because square pulls the background much closer to her face.

Solid mid-tone wardrobe. No fine patterns, which will moiré. No white, which will blow out against a soft key. Nothing in the Smart Value violet family, or she will blend into the graphics on the cut at 0:08.

AUDIO

Lav plus a boom if you have both. **Record the voice-over in the same room on the same chain as the on-camera audio.**

If the V/O is recorded later on a different mic, the cut back to her face at 0:49 will sound like a different film, and the viewer will feel it even if they cannot name it.

**SQUARE
FRAMING**

Shoot 4K 16:9 or open gate and crop to 1:1 in post, with **1:1 guides on while framing**. Compose so the square is the hero and the 16:9 is protection, not the other way round.

**EXTRA
COVERAGE**

Cheap to capture on the day, expensive to go back for.

All three hook variants, three takes each, which is what lets you A/B the opening where the reach is decided. All three closer variants. Both sections at both sizes even with two cameras running. Ten seconds of her holding a neutral look with no dialogue, at both sizes. Thirty seconds of room tone.

Half a day covers all of it comfortably.

CUT RHYTHM

Something on screen should change every two to three seconds across the whole film. The animation beats already do this in the middle sections. In the on-camera sections the punch-in cuts are the only thing providing it, **which is why they are not optional.**

OPTIONS

Alternative hooks

Shoot all three. The opening is where reach is decided and the marginal cost on the day is about ten minutes.

HOOK A **SCRIPTED**

"What if you put 8% on your best-selling SKU? Someone in the room will say revenue goes up. Will it?"

Keeps the what-if framing and turns it into a challenge rather than a riddle.

HOOK B – THE MEETING

"Someone has already asked for 8% on your biggest SKU. You have a week to answer."

Drops the viewer into a deadline instead of a hypothetical. Strongest for Finance and Commercial, who live in that meeting.

HOOK C – THE COST OF BEING RIGHT

"Eight percent on your best seller. The model says yes. The model has never met your shopper."

Sharpest scroll-stopper, more confrontational. Test this one if reach is the priority.

Alternative closers

CLOSER A SCRIPTED "So the question was never 'can we raise the price.' It's 'what happens when we do.' Simulate it first." The pause carries the construction. Works spoken, would not work written.	CLOSER B – PLAINER "Everyone can raise a price. The job is knowing what it costs you." Drops the isn't/it's construction if the delivery feels too written on the day.	CLOSER C – SHORTEST "Any of us can change a price. Knowing what it costs you is the job." Least room to fumble. Useful safety take.
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TALENT

What Mariam can and cannot say

Mariam Ghabrial is Marketing & PR Director at Marketeers, the sister company to Smart Value AI Solutions. She is not an RGM practitioner and the script must not imply otherwise. Senior commercial people can tell the difference inside one sentence.

THE RULE

She poses, the film proves. Both on-camera moments are questions. Everything that asserts anything about volume, switching or margin sits in the voice-over over graphics, where the evidence is on screen doing the arguing.

Keep that split in any rewrite and she has nothing to defend that is not hers.

WATCH ONE LINE

"Someone in the room will say revenue goes up" is observational, so it works from her. If the takes start to sound like she is claiming a seat in that room, change it to **"You'll hear someone say revenue goes up."** Decide on the day from the takes.

VOICE-OVER

Recommend Mariam carries it herself. A second voice would make the hybrid structure more obvious, but across 58 seconds with only two on-camera moments it fragments the film into three people's opinions.

The cut from her face to the shelf graphic already supplies the rhythm change. One voice keeps it one argument. If a second voice is preferred, make it noticeably lower and steadier so the hand-off reads as deliberate.

ATTRIBUTION

No lower third on the hook. The first three seconds are the most valuable real estate in the film, and a Marketeers title over a Smart Value film invites exactly the sister-company confusion worth avoiding.

The film posts from the Smart Value AI Solutions account, so credit her in the caption instead.

DELIVERY

Script the on-camera lines for structure, then give her **keyword bullets rather than a teleprompter**. The hook and the closer should sound argued, not recited. Record three takes of the hook at different energy levels.

RATIONALE

Why a straight 8% increase

Three other scenarios were on the table: pulling a promo, changing pack price architecture, and reacting to a competitor-led cut. The straight price increase wins mainly on comprehension speed.

A scrolling viewer gives you one to two seconds. **" +8% on your best seller" is legible in that window with no decoding.** "Pull the 25% promo" needs a beat of setup, and a pack architecture change needs several. In a film whose job is curiosity before product, the scenario that lands fastest wins even if it is not the most sophisticated question in the category.

It also maps cleanly onto the four outcomes. Pay it, trade down, switch brand, leave the category are the natural responses to a price going *up*. On a promo withdrawal or a competitor-led move those branches shift and the animation gets muddier.

RECOMMENDATION – SHOOT TWO FILMS

The promo question is the better second film, and it sells a different product. "What if you pulled the 25% promo on your biggest SKU?" maps onto Promotion Planner rather than Price Optimizer.

It is the more painful question for most commercial teams and closer to what they are arguing about this quarter. Once the shelf animation exists, film two is largely a re-voice and a re-label. Shoot both on the same day.

POST

Production notes

SOUND OFF
IS DEFAULT

LinkedIn's own research puts only about **37% of mobile B2B viewers** listening with sound, and captioned video holds viewers roughly a third longer.

Burn in captions rather than relying on auto-captions. Every number in the middle two sections needs an on-screen label that carries the argument alone.

ASPECT
RATIO

1:1 square master for LinkedIn. Desktop is still a large share of LinkedIn impressions and crops 4:5 badly. Produce 9:16 only for the Instagram and TikTok cutdowns.

PACE

134 words across 58 seconds is deliberately unhurried. **The pauses are part of the argument.**

ON-SCREEN
NUMBERS

No client result is cleared, so nothing on screen should be *styled* to look sourced. Moving bars, bending curves and resolving tiles, not precise figures with decimal points.

A number that looks like a claim and is not one is the fastest way to lose senior commercial people. The one validated claim available belongs in the caption, where it can be qualified.

CUTDOWNS

15s paid – hook, the competitor switch beat, end card.

30s – hook, the four shoppers, end card.

Static carousel – the four shopper outcomes, one per card.

Second film – the Promotion Planner version described above.

WHAT IF – SHOOTING SCRIPT V3

PRICE OPTIMIZER

SMART VALUE AI SOLUTIONS

0:58 · 134 WORDS · 1:1